05-07 第1篇

阅读理解（说明文） Why Do Cats Almost Always Land on Their Feet?

① If you have ever watched a cat jump down from the top of a bookshelf or a low wall, you may have noticed something very surprising. Even when a cat falls from a strange position — back-first, side-first, or upside-down — it usually hits the floor softly, on all four feet. Scientists have studied this trick for more than 100 years, and it has a special name: the **cat-righting reflex**.

② The story begins with a cat's **inner ear**. Inside every cat's ear there is a tiny organ that feels balance and direction, much like a small compass. When a cat starts to fall, this organ quickly tells the brain, "Your head is not where it should be." The cat's brain then sends orders to the body in less than a second.

③ The next key part is the **spine**. A cat's spine is much more flexible than a human's. It has more small bones, and the bones move more freely at each joint. This lets the cat twist the front half of its body one way and the back half the other way, almost like a soft rope. First the head turns, then the front legs follow, and at the end the back legs swing around so that all four feet point down.

④ Cats also use their **tail** as a small steering wheel. By moving the tail left or right in the air, the cat can balance the small spins of the body and stop itself from turning too far. Young kittens, whose tails and muscles are still growing, do not always land perfectly. With practice and age, most cats become real experts.

⑤ Finally, even the cat's body shape helps. A cat's legs are relatively long and full of strong **springs** — that is, muscles. When the paws finally touch the ground, the front legs land first and bend to **absorb** the shock. Then the back legs and the belly follow gently. The light body weight and soft paw pads also help to protect the cat's bones.

⑥ However, it is important to remember two things. First, this reflex does not work from very low heights, because the cat needs a little time in the air to twist. Second, even a perfect landing does not always protect a cat from pain. Falls from the sixth or seventh floor, for example, can still cause serious injury. So if you love cats, please close your windows in high flats, and enjoy this amazing natural "flip trick" only in quiet, safe places.

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What is the special name of the cat's falling trick?

A. The cat-dancing system.
B. The cat-running reflex.
C. The cat-righting reflex.
D. The cat-jumping habit.

2. Which body part helps a cat first notice that it is falling wrong?

A. Its tail.
B. Its paw pads.
C. Its inner ear.
D. Its claws.

3. Why can a cat twist its body so easily during a fall?

A. Its spine has more small bones and moves more freely.
B. Its bones are as hard as steel.
C. Its body is very heavy.
D. It has no bones at all.

4. Which of the following is TRUE according to the passage?

A. Young kittens always land perfectly.
B. The reflex works perfectly even from a very low jump.
C. High falls can still injure a cat seriously.
D. A cat's tail is not used during the fall.

5. What is the MAIN purpose of the passage?

A. To teach children how to catch cats.
B. To explain the science behind a cat's amazing landing skill.
C. To show that cats can fly.
D. To warn children not to keep pets.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段末 "the cat-righting reflex"
【解析】原文直接给出名字，称为 "cat-righting reflex"。A/B/D 为无中生有。故选 C。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "Inside every cat's ear there is a tiny organ..."

【解析】感知方向的器官在内耳。A 尾巴作用是转向，B 爪垫吸收冲击，D 爪子未提及。故选 C。

3.
【答案】A
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "It has more small bones, and the bones move more freely..."
【解析】猫脊柱骨头更多且关节更灵活。B 钢铁、C 太重、D 无骨均与原文相反。故选 A。

4.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解/推理判断题
【定位】第⑥段 "Falls from the sixth or seventh floor... can still cause serious injury."
【解析】高处坠落仍可能严重伤害。A 幼猫不总完美 (第④段相反)；B 低处因时间不够反而失败；D 尾巴在空中被用来平衡。故选 C。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】全文围绕"猫翻身落地的科学"展开
【解析】文章解释猫翻身落地的科学原理与注意事项。A 抓猫、C 飞行、D 禁宠均不对。故选 B。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **reflex** [n.] 反射（动作）
- **spine** [n.] 脊柱
- **paw** [n.] 爪子；爪垫
- **absorb** [v.] 吸收